

3.4.3 Where does political power reside: with the citizen, parliament or government?

- The nature of the 'First Past the Post' system based on parliamentary constituencies; the frequency of Westminster elections.
- Other voting systems used in UK elections, including proportional systems and the advantages and disadvantages of each.
- The difference between the executive, the legislature, the judiciary and the monarchy. The nature of bicameral Westminster parliament, the respective roles of and the relationship between the House of Commons and the House of Lords and the role of the monarch.
- The major political parties contesting UK general elections; key philosophical differences between the political parties operating in UK general elections.
- How parliament works: scrutinising government and making it accountable; parliamentary questions, committees, debates.
- The role of MPs; representing their constituencies, debating policy; scrutinising legislation.
- Ceremonial roles including Black Rod; key parliamentary roles including the Speaker, whips, front bench and back bench MPs.
- The legislative process; parliamentary debates and deliberation of public issues and policy.
- The formation of government by the leader of the political party with a majority in the House of Commons, or by a coalition of parties.
- The role of the Prime Minister, cabinet and ministers; the power of the Prime Minister and cabinet.
- The organisation of government administration into departments, ministries and agencies; role of the civil service.